

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear functions	Hard

Question

One gallon of paint will cover **220** square feet of a surface. A room has a total wall area of w square feet. Which equation represents the total amount of paint P , in gallons, needed to paint the walls of the room twice?

Answer

- A. $P = \frac{w}{110}$
- B. $P = 440w$
- C. $P = \frac{w}{220}$
- D. $P = 220w$

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is correct. It's given that w represents the total wall area, in square feet. Since the walls of the room will be painted twice, the amount of paint, in gallons, needs to cover $2w$ square feet. It's also given that one gallon of paint will cover **220** square feet. Dividing the total area, in square feet, of the surface to be painted by the number of square feet covered by one gallon of paint gives the number of gallons of paint that will be needed. Dividing $2w$ by **220** yields $\frac{2w}{220}$, or $\frac{w}{110}$. Therefore, the equation that represents the total amount of paint P , in gallons, needed to paint the walls of the room twice is $P = \frac{w}{110}$.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from finding the amount of paint needed to paint the walls once rather than twice.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.